GUIDE: COMPLETING THE BIOSAFETY PERMIT AMENDMENT FORM (LEVEL 1 & 2)

Instructions:

- Adhering to the instructions for completing the permit form is crucial to ensure a smooth review process and to avoid delays resulting from unclear or insufficient information.
- Ensure that you are using the **July 2025 version of the BIOSAFETY PERMIT AMENDMENT FORM (Level 1 & 2)**.
- The application package consists of the amendment form and 4 subforms:
  1. Description of Research Activities
  2. Biosafety Information
  3. Viral Vectors
  4. Assessment for Potential on Dual-Use
- **Note for Mac users:** use 'Adobe reader for Mac' for all PDF form filling and editing. Do not use Preview, which is usually the default program to open PDFs on Macs.

Section	Notes
PI and Permit Information	• Complete all sections
Biological Agents	• List the biological agents (and biological toxins) that you wish to add to the permit and/or start using (previously listed as stored) • You may also use this form to add **stored** biological agents (which will not be used at present) • Most risk groups can be found at https://health.canada.ca/en/epathogen. Note that EHS must follow PHAC guidance on risk group designation, even if this differs from other sources. • **Note: Listing of HPTA exempt cell lines** You do not need to list all of modified/derivative cell lines if you have the parent cell line on your permit unless in the following situations: ○ you have introduced something that is regulated by CFIA (e.g., a potential animal pathogen, zoonotic pathogen or part thereof) ○ you have introduced something that has the potential to alter the pathogenicity of the parent cell line in any way (e.g., introduced a toxin, altered tropism etc.). ○ if you need an import permit or BATN; then it must be specifically listed on the permit in the event of an audit (it can be added to the permit via an amendment at that time).
Description of Research Activities Subform	• Fill out the Research Activities subform. Fill one subform for each project in your research program. • Further instructions are provided in the subform.

Section	Notes
	• **Refer to further guidance provided after this table on the type of information to include for specific types of bioagents.**
Biosafety Information Subform	• Fill out the Biosafety Information subform. Fill one subform for all biological agents and research activities listed on the permit. • Further instructions are provided in the subform.
Viral Vectors Subform	• Fill out the Viral Vectors subform provided in this application package. Fill one subform for each viral vector system used. • Further instructions are provided in the subform.
Applicant Signature and Approvals	• Please sign and date the application form
Provisions for Viable Human Pathogens	• This section serves as a reference for lab members to understand the associated risks, appropriate decontamination procedures, and emergency response measures. • For viable **pathogenic** Risk Group 2 material, complete all rows **TIPS:** • Specify the concentration and contact time used for the mode of decontamination • Provide references

Additional information required for certain biological agents – to be included in the description section of the Research Activities Subform

Human tissues, fluids, primary cells

1) Source of samples: describe the population that the samples are from and any associated risks. Is the population generally healthy? Was the population screened? Is the population known to have pathogens for example are they all positive for HIV?
2) Have the samples been screened for blood borne pathogens? For what pathogens? If screened include certification of screening with permit application.
3) What volume will be handled? Risk increases with large volumes.

Animal work in conjunction with biological agents

1) Species
2) Source of the animals – i.e. commercial vendor, in-house, from another institution, pet-trade, wild-caught, or other – describe.
3) If wild-caught, provide geographical location
4) If from pet-trade, wild-caught or other source, list potential zoonoses

Toxins

1) Briefly describe what you will use the toxin for and how you will use the toxin.

Crispr/Cas9 systems

Crispr systems are not currently being tracked in our biosafety permits but due to possible regulatory implications we are asking researchers that are or are planning to use Crispr/Cas9 to send us answers to the following questions:

1) Target genes? - Germ lines or somatic cells?
2) Nature of insert
3) Vector?
4) Is the guide RNA and the Crispr together or separate?
5) Is the system dead ended or continuous?

If you are not yet working with Crispr/Cas9 systems, but decide to during the duration of your permit, please send an email to the ehs.biosafety@utoronto.ca informing us of the proposed work and answering the above questions.